

Dell launches Ubuntu Laptop

The device has a 33.7-cm (13.3-inch) touchscreen and runs the Ubuntu 12.04 operating system. The device is reportedly available in the United States right now at a price of \$1,250. This is in fact one of the few Haswell core powered laptops that are running a Linux-based operating system.

Google releases Dart SDK 1.0

Google launched version 1.0 of its Dart SDK, the company's cross-browser and open source toolkit for structured Web applications. Google considers version 1.0 as Dart's transition to a production-ready option for Web developers. Dart was first unveiled more than two years ago in October 2011. Ever since, the company has been working with early adopters to mature the project and grow its community. In fact, the Dart SDK also features the Pub package manager, with more than 500 packages written not by Google, but by third-party developers.

In addition to the actual programming language, Dart SDK 1.0 features tools and core libraries to help make development workflow "...simpler, faster, and more scalable," according to Google.

“SteamOS will boost Linux for desktops,” says Torvalds

Valve's Linux-based SteamOS platform has received the seal of approval from Linux creator Linus Torvalds himself. The man who brought Linux to the world has said that the initiative could boost the adoption of Linux on desktops. In a report by PC Pro, Torvalds commended Valve's move and said that the SteamOS could push game developers to move from the Windows platform to Linux.

Torvalds has reportedly loved the Steam announcements and thought that it would help the Linux platform to enter desktops. Valve is expected to make the SteamOS available to manufacturers for hardware integration soon.

Common sense suggests that if the SteamOS is able to break ground amongst game developers and gamers, then it would be making a dent on Microsoft's stranglehold on desktops. Torvalds himself has reportedly been having a tiff with Nvidia because the premier chipset maker has failed to provide driver support for open source software through its graphics chips. Since the arrival of SteamOS though, Nvidia has developed systems for Linux users.

Torvalds also said that the way Steam is going, developers need to buck up and follow them. This would ensure that people also play games on Steam platforms.